

Policy statement 573 - Artificial Intelligence and engineering responsibility

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Approved by the Task Committee on Artificial Intelligence on February 15, 2024

Approved by the Public Policy and Practice Committee on May 1, 2024

Adopted by the Board on Direction on July 18, 2024

Policy

The American Society of Civil Engineers (ASCE) recognizes the growing significance of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the field of civil engineering, however ASCE believes that the civil engineer must maintain responsibility for project planning, designing, building, operations, maintenance, and the protection of the public health, safety, and welfare. AI cannot serve as a replacement for the professional judgement of a licensed Professional Engineer.

Issue

As technology continues to advance, AI has the potential to enhance efficiency, innovation, and sustainability in civil engineering practices. AI

remains a tool that has great potential to enhance civil engineering processes. However, AI cannot be held accountable, nor can it replace the training, experience, and judgement of a professional engineer in the planning, designing, building, and operation of civil engineering projects and the protection of the public health, safety, and welfare.

Rationale

AI has already made substantial contributions to the field of civil engineering. The rapid advancement of AI technology is outstripping current laws and regulations. Governments at all levels as well as private industry are currently seeking to understand and regulate AI applications across many industries. Protecting public health, safety, and welfare remains the primary focus in the use of AI under the direction of a licensed professional engineer.

ASCE Policy Statement 573
First Approved 2024

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

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